

Japan packing checklist

Carry-on first: trains, steps, coin lockers, humidity, and long walking days.

Shoes and feet

- ☐ One broken-in pair for 15k to 25k steps daily. No brand new shoes on day one.
- ☐ Breathable socks, blister pads, and a spare pair if rain soaks through.
- ☐ Slides or indoor shoes if your hotel or ryokan expects it.

Bags and trains

- ☐ Soft duffel or backpack beats a rigid case for Shinkansen overhead rules and coin lockers.
- ☐ Pack a foldable day bag for snacks, water, umbrella, and a light layer.
- ☐ Keep a small pouch for coins, IC card, and ticket stubs.

Weather and layers

- ☐ Light rain shell that packs small. Umbrella optional if you prefer hands free.
- ☐ Thin mid layer for strong AC on trains and muggy streets in the same afternoon.
- ☐ Sun hat or cap for summer, thin gloves and liner for Hokkaido winter.

Power and documents

- ☐ Type A plug adapter if your charger is not dual voltage. USB-C hub optional.
- ☐ Passport copy offline, hotel vouchers, and one backup card not in the same pocket as primary.
- ☐ Travel insurance card and embassy number in notes, offline.

Toiletries and laundry

- ☐ Travel size first, buy refills at a drugstore after arrival if you stay long.
- ☐ Laundry soap sheets or a small bag for coin laundry on week two.
- ☐ Hand sanitizer and tissues: public restrooms vary by building.